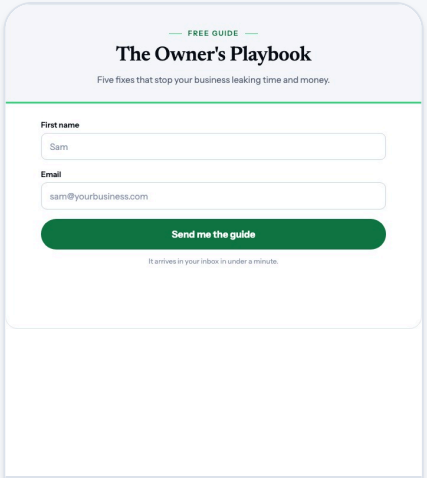
Case study · GoHighLevel automation

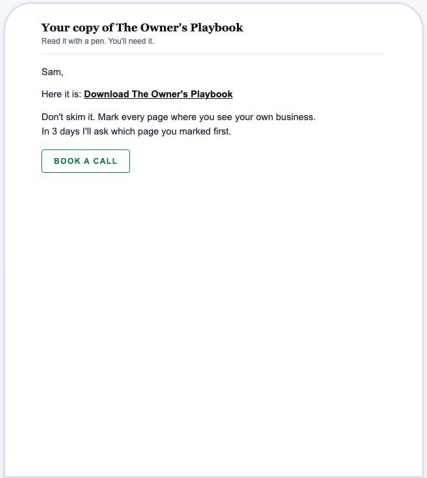
Turning a free download into a lead-capture system

The client, a service business, gives away free resources on its website: a short ebook and a downloadable guide. Each one was a plain PDF link, so anyone could grab it and nobody knew who did. I put every resource behind a short GoHighLevel form, so each download becomes a contact, gets the resource by email, and receives a follow-up three days later that starts a conversation.

2	2	3	0
free resources gated	emails per download	days to the follow-up	manual steps per lead



The download form on the website



The delivery email, seconds later

The brief

- **Know who downloads:** every download should become a contact, not an anonymous click.
- **Get emails opened:** the resource should arrive by email, so the first email gets opened.
- **Start a conversation:** follow up once they've had time to read, and invite a reply or an enquiry.

What I built

- **Download forms** (first name, email) with branded headers that match the website.
- **A thank-you message** on submit that sends people to their inbox.
- **2 HTML emails per resource:** delivery and a 3-day follow-up, with a branded footer and enquiry button.
- **Workflows:** one per resource, plus an optional reply alert.

Design principles

- **Deliver by email, not redirect:** the resource is only in the email, which confirms the address and lifts open rates.
- **Ask, don't pitch:** the follow-up asks one question readers can answer by reply.
- **No repeats:** re-entry is off, so nobody gets the sequence twice.

Problems solved

- **A PDF link can't trigger a follow-up:** GoHighLevel can't email someone it doesn't know, so the link moved behind a form.
- **The redirect skipped the email:** the form opened the PDF straight away, so nobody needed the email. On submit now shows a message instead.
- **Replies going unseen:** a reply workflow alerts the owner and tags the contact.

Workflows · full maps

From download to conversation

Workflow 1: Free resource downloaded

Live and tested

One copy of this workflow per resource. Allow re-entry is off.

- **TRIGGER** Form submitted
  Free resource download form (first name, email)
- **ACTION** Add tag
  resource: downloaded
- **EMAIL** Delivery email
  Sent straight away: "Your copy of [resource]", with the download link
- **WAIT** Wait 3 days
  Time to actually read it
- **EMAIL** Follow-up email
  One question they can answer by reply, plus an enquiry button
- END

Workflow 2: Reader replied

Optional add-on

Catches replies to the follow-up question, so none sit unread.

- **TRIGGER** Customer replied
  Channel: email · filter: tag "resource: downloaded"
- **TEAM** Internal notification
  The owner sees the reply straight away
- **ACTION** Add tag
  resource: replied
- END

Form, on submit

Shows a message instead of opening the PDF, so the only way to the resource is the email.

MESSAGE

Done. Check your inbox. Your copy is waiting in your email.

Email 1: delivery (straight away)

SUBJECT

Your copy of [resource]

PREVIEW TEXT

Read it with a pen. You'll need it.

Download link, one line on how to read it, and a heads-up that a question is coming in 3 days.

Email 2: follow-up (after 3 days)

SUBJECT

Which page did you mark first?

One honest question to reply to, the enquiry button, and the download link again for anyone who hasn't opened it.

TRIGGER Trigger · ACTION Action · EMAIL Email to lead · TEAM Team alert · WAIT Wait